asserts that government or political system is a sub system of a larger social system. This approach examines the interaction between the larger and the sub systems.

Early ***Montesque*** proposed a three-fold division of Government namely Republican, Monarchical and Despotic government

Republican Government: "People possess the sovereign Power".

Monarchical Government: "Rule by one single person and governed by fixed and established laws".

Despotic government: "Rule by one single person but there is no fixed rule for governance, everything conducted by his will. According to ***Montesque*** the survival of the government depends on "persistence in given society of that particular spirit which is characteristic of the form".

6.2 Meaning, Definition and Nature of Government

Government refers to the executive functions of the state. It denotes a body having authority to make and enforce laws applicable to the civil, corporate, religious, academic or other groups. The term Government is derived from an old French word "governor", derived from Latin word "gubernare" which means to direct, rule, guide, govern.

Which is the oldest form of government?

Aristotle's **Classification of Governments**

Aristotle identified a combination of two criteria to classify the constitution that he analysed.





Monarchy is the oldest form of government in the United Kingdom. In a monarchy, a king or queen is the Head of State. The British monarchy is known as a constitutional monarchy. This means that, while The Sovereign is Head of State, the ability to make and pass legislation resides with an elected Parliament.

Criteria One:

Number of People having Power – One, Few, Many; Thus he distinguished between Monarchy, Aristocracy and Polity

Criteria Two:

To whose interest the Government works for – Working in General Interest, Working in Personal Interest. The respective perverted forms of the three types are Tyranny, Oligarchy and Democracy

No of People having Power	Working in General Interest	Working in Personal Interest
One	Monarchy	Tyranny
Few	Aristocracy	Oligarchy
Many	Polity	Democracy or Mobocracy

ACTIVITY

"Every activity of individuals from 'Womb to tomb' is regulated and controlled by the State agencies."

11th Std Political Science Eng Medium Vol-1 Page 143-170 Chapter 6.indd 88 07/12/2022 16:41:11